THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The tone of the narrator when describing Horace's habits is: 1

(a) wry **(b)** furious **(c)** sad **(d)** solemn

2. A fair summary of the theme is: 1

(a) excessive trust and greed bring downfall **(b)** science is dangerous
(c) books are costly **(d)** poverty is crime

3. The ending, with Horace in the library, is a form of: 1

(a) escape **(b)** revenge
(c) plain tragedy **(d)** poetic justice with a twist

4. Which idiom suits Horace's fate? 1

(a) to be hoist with one's own petard **(b)** to break the ice
(c) to kill two birds **(d)** to spill the beans

5. The effect of the final reversal is to: 1

(a) cause anger **(b)** leave a smile and a lesson
(c) end the mystery sadly **(d)** create tears

6. Which statement best captures the moral ambiguity of the story? 1

(a) a thief is both victim and offender **(b)** the woman is honest
(c) a policeman is a thief **(d)** a book is evil

7. What does Horace's love of books symbolise? 1

(a) idleness **(b)** poverty
(c) a refined passion that leads him astray **(d)** violence

8. Choose the correct reported speech: The inspector said, 'Your fingerprints are everywhere.' 1

(a) The inspector said that his fingerprints were everywhere.
(b) The inspector told fingerprints everywhere.
(c) The inspector said that your fingerprints are everywhere.
(d) The inspector said his fingerprints is everywhere.

9. The phrase 'honour among thieves' is: 1

(a) true for Horace **(b)** absent in this story
(c) illustrated by the woman **(d)** about the police

10. If the woman had been honest, the story would lose: 1

(a) its irony and moral **(b)** its setting

(c) its title **(d)** its narrator

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the story say about the relationship between planning and chance? 2

12. What makes the woman a credible deceiver? 2

13. Discuss whether the story is a moral tale. 2

14. Is Horace more foolish or unlucky? Give reasons. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the claim that the story is a satire. 3

16. Change the voice and comment: 'The woman fooled the thief completely.' 3

17. Imagine the woman writing about her night's work. What would she say about Horace? 3

OR

Discuss how the story combines suspense and humour. 3

18. Complete using appropriate connectors: Horace was careful; ___, he left fingerprints. ___ he was polite, he was a thief. 3

OR

What does the story imply about the cost of a passion? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a dialogue between Horace and the prison governor who learns he is a librarian by choice. 5

OR

Write a letter to the editor on the topic 'Do not trust strangers blindly'. 5

20. Evaluate the structure of the plot. 5

OR

Do you think the story rewards or punishes Horace? Justify. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND